

Colour Guidelines

Social media · colour system v8 · two themes, four moods · October 2026

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Principles

Six rules behind every colour decision.

01 Two colours never change.

Slate Blue #416D95 and Sage Teal #74AFAD are the logo's colours. Exactly as they are, in every theme, and as the accent bar on every post.

02 Two themes, four moods.

Light and dark, each in a Royal (blue) and a Lagoon (teal) mood. The pillar picks the mood, so the feed has rhythm.

03 Punch from saturation, not darkness.

Light posts stay light: their colour mass is a bright mid-tone, never a dark block. Dark posts glow from within.

04 One colour mass per post.

One saturated shape carries the eye. Highlight colour goes on 1–3 words only.

05 Tinted, never grey.

Shadows, borders and glows are tinted navy, royal or lagoon. No neutral grey and no pure white ground.

06 Readable first.

Every text colour is listed with the grounds it passes on, measured at the worst point of each gradient.

Core colours

Fixed. Taken from the logo and the website. Never tinted, shaded or substituted.



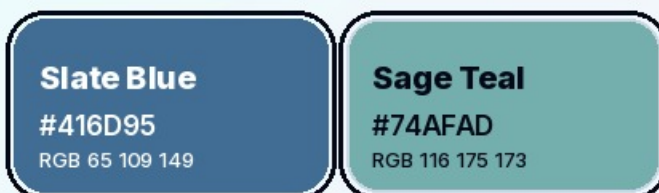
Brand gradient · #416D95 to #74AFAD · the logo, and the accent bar on every post

- Slate Blue: decorative on light (logo, accent bar); as text only on white (5.5:1).
- Sage Teal: supporting text on Dark Lagoon (6.4:1); never text on light.

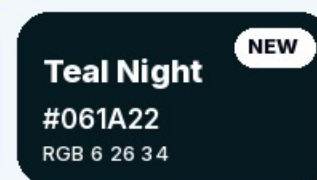
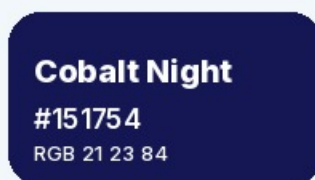
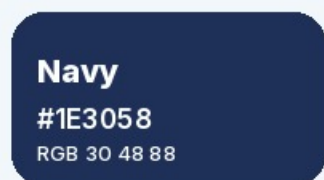
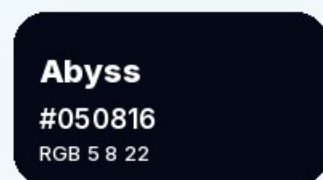
Full palette

Twenty colours in five families. NEW marks the five added in v8.

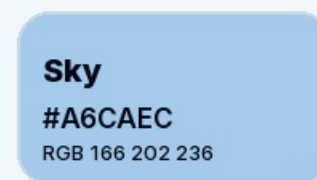
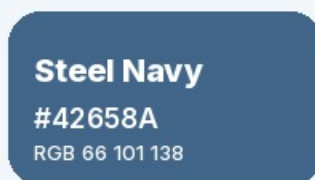
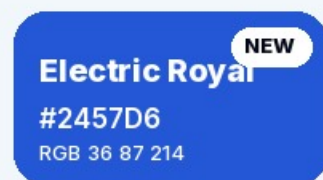
CORE · FIXED



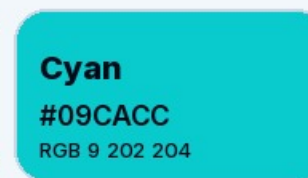
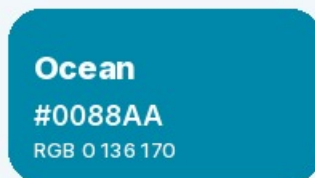
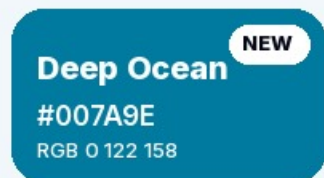
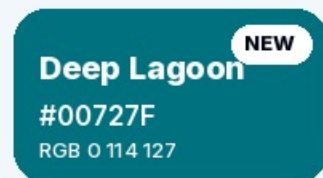
DEEP



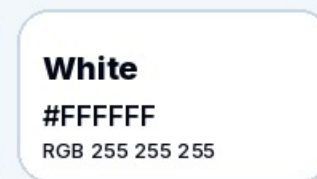
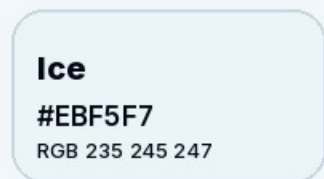
BLUES



TEALS



LIGHTS



Retired: Royal Deep #2F62C8 (replaced by Electric Royal). Never: yellow, lime, orange, coral, green as the brand colour.

Gradients

Fixed stops. Grounds, colour masses and highlights for each mood.



Brand · logo + accent bar
#416D95 · #74AFAD



Royal Tide · light mass
#2457D6 · #3C6EB7



Lagoon Tide · light mass
#00727F · #0088AA · #00ACB3



Royal Aurora · dark mass
#0B1A3A · #21387B · #2457D6



Lagoon Aurora · dark mass
#062A33 · #00727F · #0088AA



Highlight · Light Royal
#2457D6 · #007A9E



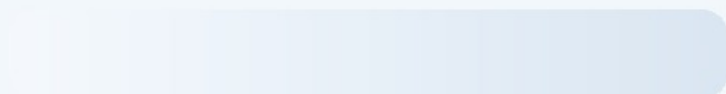
Highlight · Light Lagoon
#007A9E · #00727F



Highlight · Dark Royal
#A6CAEC · #09CACC



Highlight · Dark Lagoon
#09CACC · #34CCA4



Mist ground · Light Royal
#F5F9FD · #E8F0F8 · #DAE6F2



Polar ground · Light Lagoon
#F2FAFA · #E3F3F3 · #D2EBEC



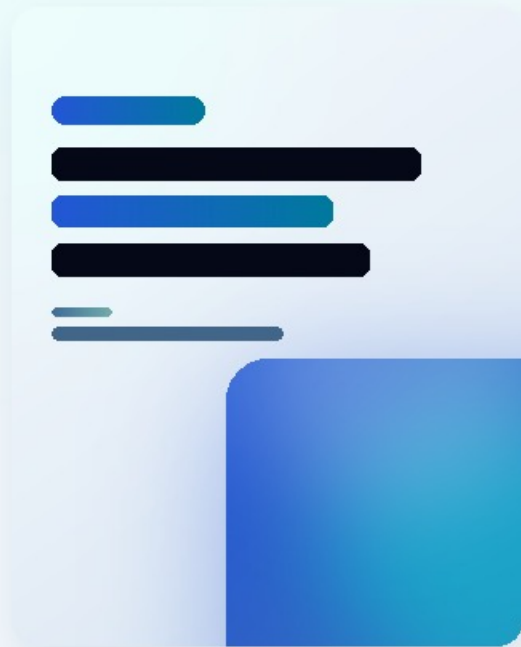
Abyss ground · Dark Royal
#050816 · #0A1030 · #12164A



Teal Night ground · Dark Lagoon
#040C12 · #061A22 · #08262F

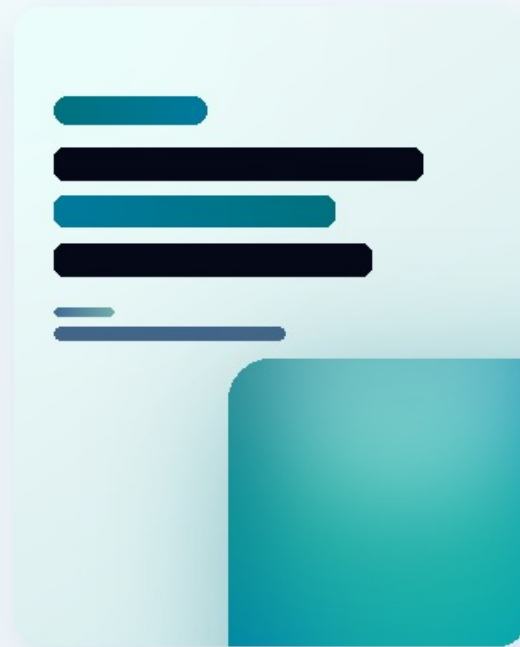
Themes and moods

The pillar picks the mood. No two posts in a row share a theme and mood.



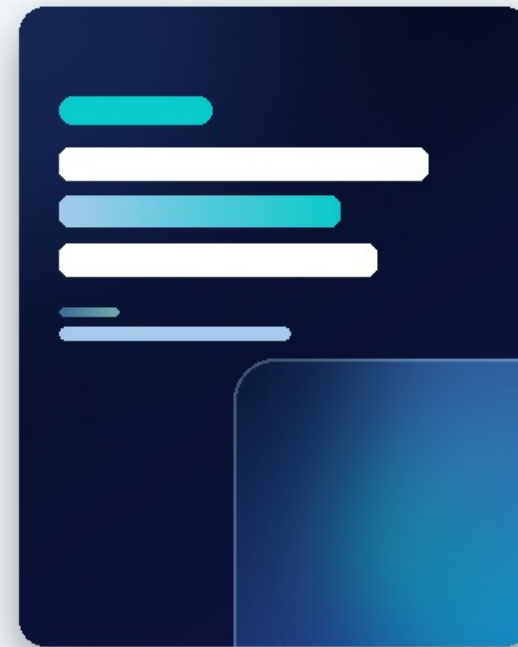
Light Royal

How we work (Tue, Sun) · Proof (Thu)



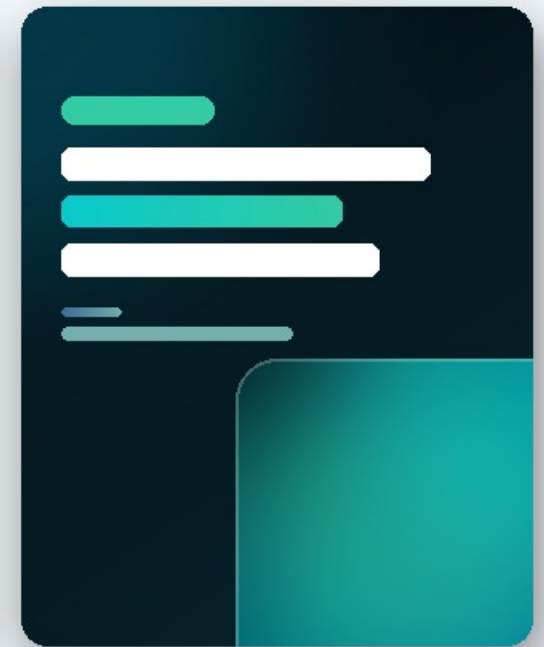
Light Lagoon

Grow with us (Fri)



Dark Royal

Engineering insight (Mon, Wed)



Dark Lagoon

Brand world (Sat)

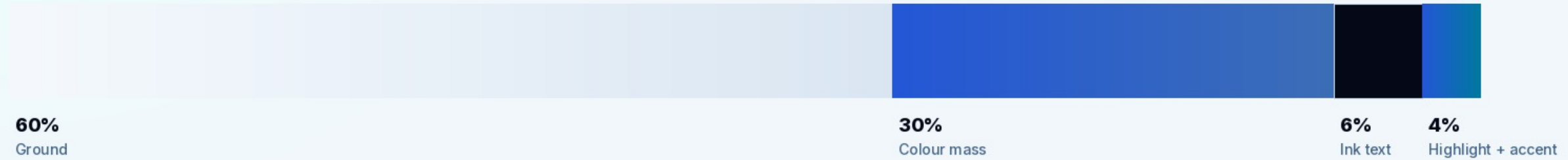
THE WEEK

Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
Dark Royal	Light Royal	Dark Royal	Light Royal	Light Lagoon	Dark Lagoon	Light Royal
Insight	How we work	Insight	Proof	Grow with us	Brand world	How we work

Proportions

How much of each colour a post uses. The ground dominates; highlight stays small.

LIGHT THEME



DARK THEME



- Colour mass: 25–40% of the frame. Ground: at least 50%.
- Highlight colour on 1–3 words; the accent bar is the only other accent.

Contrast at a glance

Worst case across each mood's ground. 4.5:1 for small text, 3:1 for headlines.

LIGHT ROYAL

Aa	Headline #050816 on #DAE6F2 (worst case)
Aa	Supporting #42658A on #DAE6F2 (worst case)
Aa	Highlight start #2457D6 on #DAE6F2 (worst case)
Aa	Highlight end #007A9E on #DAE6F2 (worst case)

15.8:1	OK
4.8:1	OK
4.9:1	OK
3.9:1	OK

DARK ROYAL

Aa	Headline #FFFFFF on #12164A (worst case)
Aa	Supporting #A6CAEC on #12164A (worst case)
Aa	Highlight start #A6CAEC on #12164A (worst case)
Aa	Highlight end #09CACC on #12164A (worst case)

16.9:1	OK
9.9:1	OK
9.9:1	OK
8.3:1	OK

LIGHT LAGOON

Aa	Headline #050816 on #D2EBEC (worst case)
Aa	Supporting #42658A on #D2EBEC (worst case)
Aa	Highlight start #007A9E on #D2EBEC (worst case)
Aa	Highlight end #00727F on #D2EBEC (worst case)

16.0:1	OK
4.9:1	OK
3.9:1	OK
4.5:1	OK

DARK LAGOON

Aa	Headline #FFFFFF on #08262F (worst case)
Aa	Supporting #74AFAD on #08262F (worst case)
Aa	Highlight start #09CACC on #08262F (worst case)
Aa	Highlight end #34CCA4 on #08262F (worst case)

15.8:1	OK
6.4:1	OK
7.8:1	OK
7.8:1	OK

Logo colours

The logo keeps its own colours. Choose the lockup by the ground behind it.



Gradient lockup · Light Royal



Gradient lockup · Light Lagoon



White lockup · Dark Royal

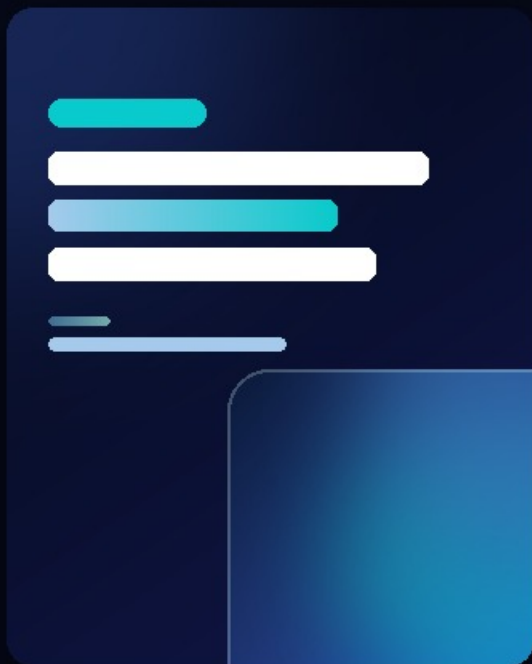


White lockup · Dark Lagoon

- Never recolour the logo to match a post, never place it on the colour mass or a busy area, never add glow or outline.
- The logo gradient is Slate Blue to Sage Teal and is never edited.

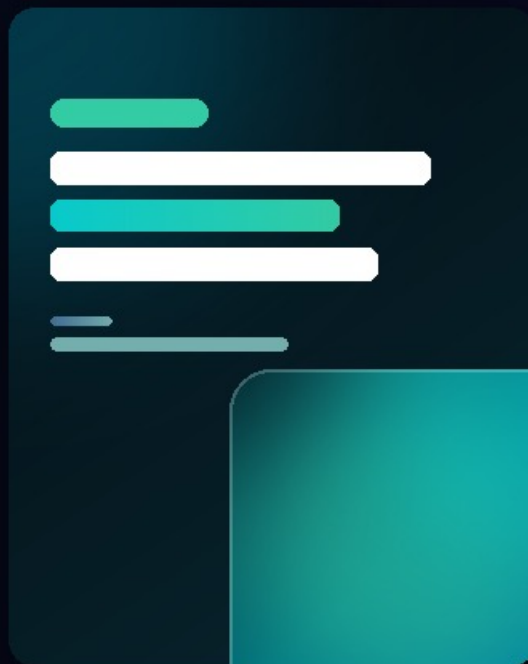
Dark theme

Glowing from within, never neon.



Dark Royal

Focused and technical. A royal aurora glowing out of the abyss.



Dark Lagoon

Deep and atmospheric. A lagoon aurora in teal night.

WHAT STAYS THE SAME IN BOTH MOODS

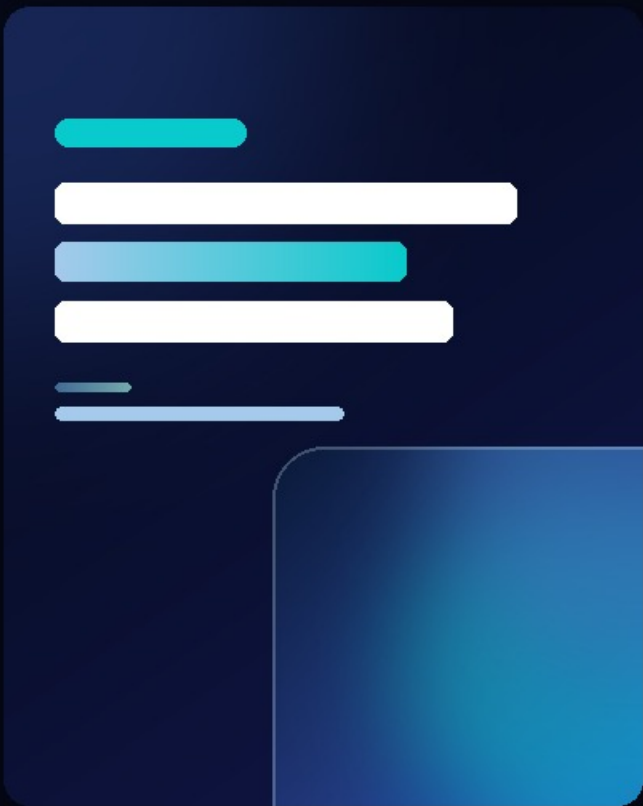
- Headline in White, Inter 800
- One aurora mass with a fine Polar edge; no drop shadows on dark
- Accent bar: brand gradient Slate Blue to Sage Teal
- Pill: solid bright fill, Abyss text
- White logo lockup

WHAT CHANGES WITH THE MOOD

- Ground tint, colour mass, highlight gradient, pill colour, line colour, supporting text

Dark Royal

Focused and technical. A royal aurora glowing out of the abyss. For: Engineering insight (Mon, Wed).



Ground

Gradient, glow #21387B at 60% top-left · #050816 · #0A1030 · #12164A



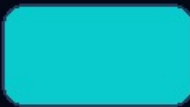
Headline

Inter 800 · #FFFFFF



Supporting text

Sublines, captions, footer · #A6CAEC



Pill

Text #050816 · #09CACC



Lines and borders

Hairlines, card borders · #1C2B4E



Colour mass · Royal Aurora

Glow: #09CACC at 35% (centre-right), #3C6EB7 at 40% (top-right) · #0B1A3A · #21387B · #2457D6



Highlight words

1–3 words · #A6CAEC · #09CACC



Meta text

Counters, small labels · #74AFAD



Accent bar

Brand gradient · #416D95 · #74AFAD

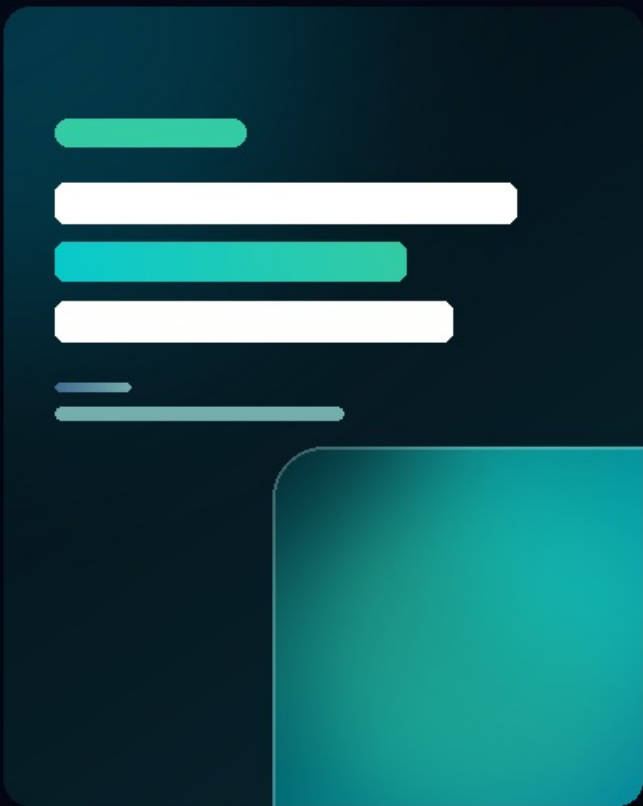


Logo

white lockup · #FFFFFF

Dark Lagoon

Deep and atmospheric. A lagoon aurora in teal night. For: Brand world (Sat).



Ground
Gradient, glow #0088AA at 35% top-left · #040C12 · #061A22 · #08262F



Headline
Inter 800 · #FFFFFF



Supporting text
Sublines, captions, footer · #74AFAD



Pill
Text #050816 · #34CCA4



Lines and borders
Hairlines, card borders · #163A42



Colour mass · Lagoon Aurora
Glow: #34CCA4 at 35% (centre), #09CACC at 30% (top-right) · #062A33 · #00727F · #0088AA



Highlight words
1–3 words · #09CACC · #34CCA4



Meta text
Counters, small labels · #A6CAEC



Accent bar
Brand gradient · #416D95 · #74AFAD



Logo
white lockup · #FFFFFF

Surfaces and depth

Depth from edges and glow, never drop shadows.

L0 Ground · #050816 · #0A1030 · #12164A

L1 Surface · #0B1530

border #1C2B4E

L2 Raised · white 8% glass

border Polar 12% inner top edge

L3 Royal Aurora · edge Polar at 25%

Dark Royal

L0 Ground · #040C12 · #061A22 · #08262F

L1 Surface · #0A2028

border #163A42

L2 Raised · white 8% glass

border Polar 12% inner top edge

L3 Lagoon Aurora · edge Polar at 25%

Dark Lagoon

Text colour and contrast

Measured at the worst point of each ground gradient, and on surfaces and the mass.

DARK ROYAL

Aa	Headline #FFFFFF on #12164A (worst case)	16.9:1	OK
Aa	Highlight start #A6CAEC on #12164A (worst case)	9.9:1	OK
Aa	Highlight end #09CACC on #12164A (worst case)	8.3:1	OK
Aa	Supporting #A6CAEC on #12164A (worst case)	9.9:1	OK
Aa	Meta #74AFAD on #12164A (worst case)	6.8:1	OK
Aa	Pill text #050816 on #09CACC (worst case)	9.8:1	OK
Aa	Text on the mass #FFFFFF on #21387B (worst case)	11.0:1	OK

DARK LAGOON

Aa	Headline #FFFFFF on #08262F (worst case)	15.8:1	OK
Aa	Highlight start #09CACC on #08262F (worst case)	7.8:1	OK
Aa	Highlight end #34CCA4 on #08262F (worst case)	7.8:1	OK
Aa	Supporting #74AFAD on #08262F (worst case)	6.4:1	OK
Aa	Meta #A6CAEC on #08262F (worst case)	9.2:1	OK
Aa	Pill text #050816 on #34CCA4 (worst case)	9.8:1	OK
Aa	Text on the mass #FFFFFF on #00727F (worst case)	5.7:1	OK

Text on the mass: White only, headline size, at the mass's darkest end. Body text never sits on the mass.

Glows and automatic checks

Exact glow recipes, and the checks the pipeline runs on every image.

DARK ROYAL



Ground glow: #21387B at 60%, top-left, very soft (blur about a third of the frame)



Mass glow: #09CACC at 35%, centre-right



Mass glow: #3C6EB7 at 40%, top-right

Mass edge: Polar #E9FFFC at 25%, 1-2 px; no drop shadow

DARK LAGOON



Ground glow: #0088AA at 35%, top-left, very soft (blur about a third of the frame)



Mass glow: #34CCA4 at 35%, centre



Mass glow: #09CACC at 30%, top-right

Mass edge: Polar #E9FFFC at 25%, 1-2 px; no drop shadow

AUTOMATIC CHECK · DARK

- Mean luminance of the image at most 0.15
- At least 2% of pixels brighter than luminance 0.50 (the glow)
- Glow and highlight together cover at most 25% of the frame
- Fail any check: regenerate. Never publish a light post that reads half-dark, or a dark post with no glow.

Do and don't

Do

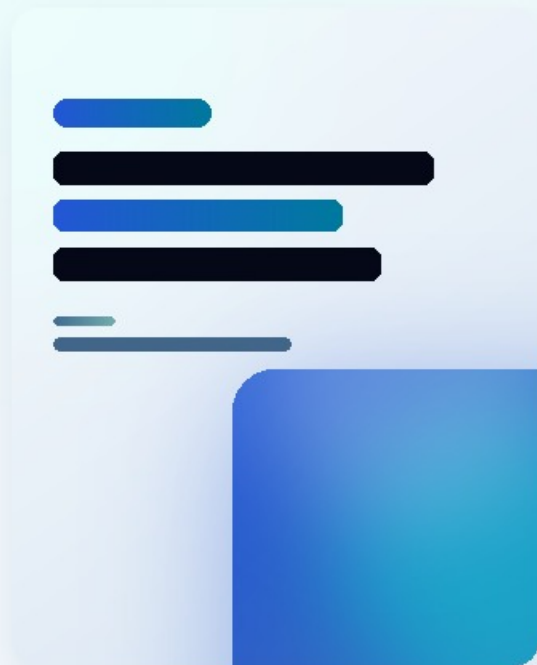
- Pick the mood by pillar: Royal for Insight, Lagoon for Brand world
- One aurora mass, glowing from within, with a fine Polar edge
- White headlines; Sky (Royal) or Sage Teal (Lagoon) supporting text
- Highlight 1–3 words: Sky to Cyan, or Cyan to Mint Jade
- Pill: solid Cyan or Mint Jade with Abyss text
- Brand-gradient accent bar on every post

Don't

- Royal navy (#194493-style) or pure black grounds
- Drop shadows on dark; use edges and glow instead
- Every element glowing; more than one glow source competing
- White text on Cyan or Mint Jade (2.0:1)
- Mint Jade as a large fill (it starts to read as green)
- Yellow, lime, orange, coral

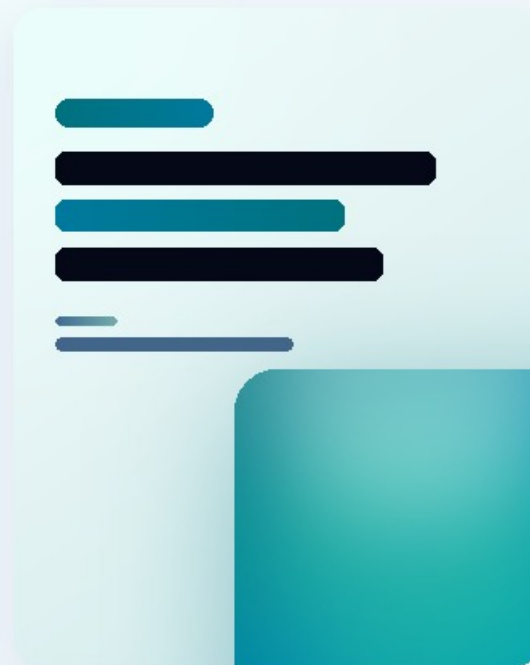
Light theme

Light and luminous. Punch from saturated colour and strong ink, never from a dark block.



Light Royal

Bright and confident. A luminous royal-blue mass on misty white.



Light Lagoon

Fresh and human. A deep-lagoon mass on polar white.

WHAT STAYS THE SAME IN BOTH MOODS

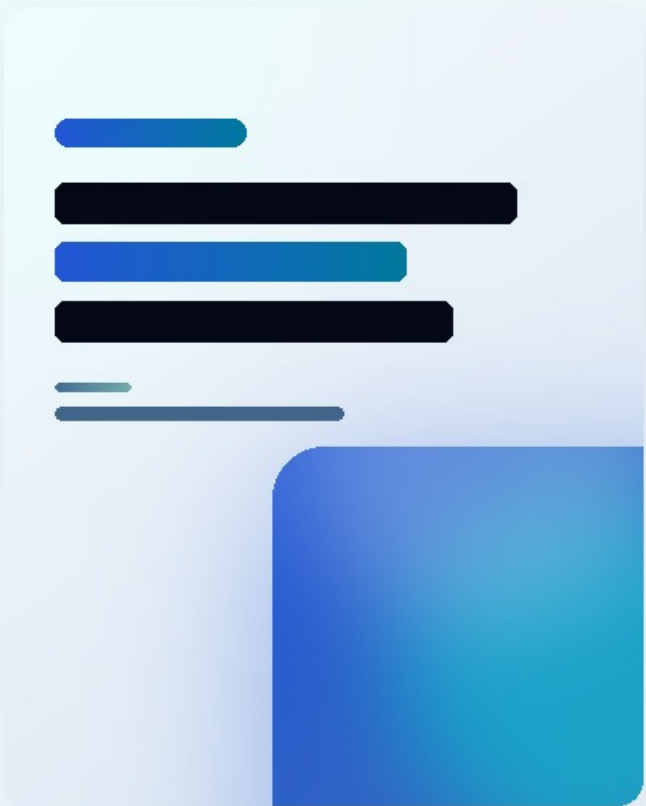
- Headline in Abyss #050816, Inter 800
- One bright colour mass with a tinted shadow; Cobalt never used as a fill
- Accent bar: brand gradient Slate Blue to Sage Teal
- Pill: gradient fill, white text
- Supporting text in Steel Navy #42658A
- Gradient logo lockup

WHAT CHANGES WITH THE MOOD

- Ground tint, colour mass, highlight gradient, pill colour, line colour

Light Royal

Bright and confident. A luminous royal-blue mass on misty white. For: How we work (Tue, Sun) · Proof (Thu).



Ground

Gradient, glow #E9FFFC at 70% top-left · #F5F9FD · #E8F0F8 · #DAE6F2



Headline

Inter 800 · #050816



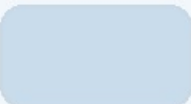
Supporting text

Sublines, captions, footer · #42658A



Pill

Text #FFFFFF · #2457D6 · #007A9E



Lines and borders

Hairlines, card borders · #C9DCEC



Colour mass · Royal Tide

Glow: #09CACC at 40% (centre-right), #A6CAEC at 30% (top edge sheen) · #2457D6 · #3C6EB7



Highlight words

1-3 words · #2457D6 · #007A9E



Meta text

Counters, small labels · #42658A



Accent bar

Brand gradient · #416D95 · #74AFAD

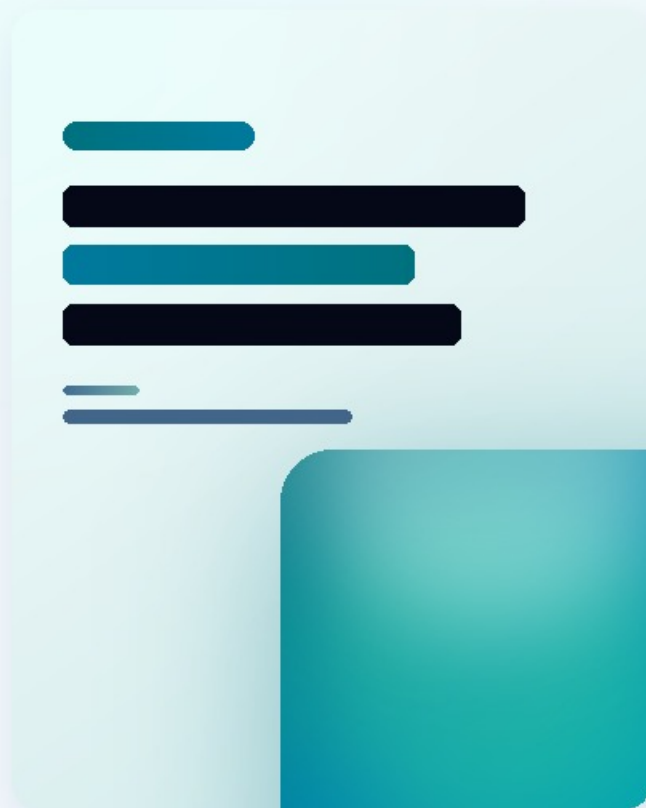


Logo

gradient lockup · #416D95 · #74AFAD

Light Lagoon

Fresh and human. A deep-lagoon mass on polar white. For: Grow with us (Fri).



Ground

Gradient, glow #E9FFFC at 70% top-left · #F2FAFA · #E3F3F3 · #D2EBEC

Headline

Inter 800 · #050816

Supporting text

Sublines, captions, footer · #42658A

Pill

Text #FFFFFF · #00727F · #007A9E

Lines and borders

Hairlines, card borders · #BFDDE0

Colour mass · Lagoon Tide

Glow: #34CCA4 at 35% (centre), #E9FFFC at 30% (top edge sheen) · #00727F · #0088AA · #00ACB3

Highlight words

1–3 words · #007A9E · #00727F

Meta text

Counters, small labels · #42658A

Accent bar

Brand gradient · #416D95 · #74AFAD

Logo

gradient lockup · #416D95 · #74AFAD

Surfaces and depth

Four levels. Shadows are tinted with the mood colour, never grey.



Light Royal



Light Lagoon

Text colour and contrast

Measured at the worst point of each ground gradient, and on surfaces and the mass.

LIGHT ROYAL

Aa	Headline #050816 on #DAE6F2 (worst case)	15.8:1	OK
Aa	Highlight start #2457D6 on #DAE6F2 (worst case)	4.9:1	OK
Aa	Highlight end #007A9E on #DAE6F2 (worst case)	3.9:1	OK
Aa	Supporting #42658A on #DAE6F2 (worst case)	4.8:1	OK
Aa	Meta #42658A on #DAE6F2 (worst case)	4.8:1	OK
Aa	Pill text #FFFFFF on #007A9E (worst case)	4.9:1	OK
Aa	Text on the mass #FFFFFF on #3C6EB7 (worst case)	5.1:1	OK

LIGHT LAGOON

Aa	Headline #050816 on #D2EBEC (worst case)	16.0:1	OK
Aa	Highlight start #007A9E on #D2EBEC (worst case)	3.9:1	OK
Aa	Highlight end #00727F on #D2EBEC (worst case)	4.5:1	OK
Aa	Supporting #42658A on #D2EBEC (worst case)	4.9:1	OK
Aa	Meta #42658A on #D2EBEC (worst case)	4.9:1	OK
Aa	Pill text #FFFFFF on #007A9E (worst case)	4.9:1	OK
Aa	Text on the mass #FFFFFF on #0088AA (worst case)	4.1:1	OK

Text on the mass: White only, headline size, at the mass’s darkest end. Body text never sits on the mass. Slate Blue is never small text on light (4.3:1 worst case); Cyan, Mint Jade, Sage Teal and Polar are never text on light.

Glows and automatic checks

Exact glow recipes, and the checks the pipeline runs on every image.

LIGHT ROYAL

-  Ground glow: #E9FFFC at 70%, top-left, very soft (blur about a third of the frame)
-  Mass glow: #09CACC at 40%, centre-right
-  Mass glow: #A6CAEC at 30%, top edge sheen
-  Mass shadow: #2457D6 at 28%, offset 30 px down, blur 70 px

LIGHT LAGOON

-  Ground glow: #E9FFFC at 70%, top-left, very soft (blur about a third of the frame)
-  Mass glow: #34CCA4 at 35%, centre
-  Mass glow: #E9FFFC at 30%, top edge sheen
-  Mass shadow: #00727F at 26%, offset 30 px down, blur 70 px

AUTOMATIC CHECK · LIGHT

- Mean luminance of the image at least 0.55
- At most 6% of pixels darker than luminance 0.10
- No fill darker than the mood's darkest mass stop, except text
- Fail any check: regenerate. Never publish a light post that reads half-dark, or a dark post with no glow.

Do and don't

Do

- Pick the mood by pillar: Royal for How we work and Proof, Lagoon for Grow with us
- One bright colour mass, 25–40% of the frame, tinted shadow
- Abyss headlines; Steel Navy supporting text
- Highlight 1–3 words: Electric Royal to Deep Ocean, or Deep Ocean to Deep Lagoon
- White cards and glass with tinted borders
- Brand-gradient accent bar on every post

Don't

- Cobalt Night, Navy or Abyss as a fill (light posts stay light)
- Pure white ground; grey shadows
- Cyan, Mint Jade, Sage Teal or Polar as text
- Body text on the colour mass
- Pastel-only, washed-out posts
- Yellow, lime, orange, coral

Let's build it **right.**

verdant-soft.com · info@verdant-soft.com · Lahore, Pakistan

